

Facebook overhauls messages

Facebook is going one step ahead on converting its message service into a fully advanced email client by announcing its new look. <http://dgit.in/QzBjC6>



TouchFire for iPad

TouchFire is a flexible, thin keyboard for your iPad and that makes your typing easier. Looks cool right? <http://dgit.in/OW39rS>

Bazaar

Samsung UA55ES8000RLXL Smart TV

Have money? Should buy!

There are a lot of shiny elements to this TV despite sporting a brushed finish. The TV features a split stand that's sturdy and looks brilliant. The bezel is also very slim and even manages to integrate a webcam.

The TV comes with two remotes: a conventional one and a touch sensitive remote as well. The latter is essentially a stripped down version of the primary remote, with only the very essential buttons on it, the major area being taken up by the touchpad.

Compared with say, LG, the Samsung Smart Hub offers a lot more variety in terms of apps. It also allows for network sharing so media can be



directly streamed to the TV. This Samsung TV showcases its smartness via the unconventional control methods that it features. First up is voice control, which works surprisingly well. It did not seem to have any issues with accents or ambient noise and managed to understand our commands

without any problem. The second method of control is via gestures. The webcam tracks your movements, we wouldn't recommend it though.

We found that its contrast ratio stood at 983:1, a decent score. Colour reproduction is nice and even and watching HD movies via Blu-ray is fantastic.

We played 3D content off a 3D Blu-ray disc and also tried 2D videos in 3D mode, converted via the TV. In both cases, the effect was quite good, even for non-3D content. Worth buying if you can afford it.

Visbal Mathur

Specifications

Size: 55-inches; **Panel type:** LED, with micro dimming; **Ports:** 3 HDMI, 3 USB ports, composite, component, Ethernet, integrated Wi-Fi, optical audio out; **Clear Motion Rate:** 800Hz; **Active 3D:** Yes

Contact

Samsung India
Phone: (City Code) 30308282
Email: <http://www.samsung.com/in/support/erms1>
Price: ₹2,67,000

8.0/10

Features	8.5
Performance.....	8.0
Build Quality	8.0
Value for Money	7.0

Specifications

Operating System: Android 4.0.1; **System-On-Chip:**

Allwinner A10 Cortex A8 1.5GHz; **Memory:** 1 GB DDR3;

Internal Storage: 4GB flash storage; **Audio format support:**

AAC, AAC+, eAAC+, MP3, OGG, WMA, WAV, MIDI,

M4A; **Video format Support:**

WMV, AVI, DivX, MP4,

MPEG-2, H.264

Contact

Koway Tech / Email: jason_shell@hotmail.com

Website: www.kowaytech.com

Price: ₹4,500

6.0/10

Features	7.0
Performance.....	5.0
Build Quality	4.0
Value for Money	7.5

Android 4.0 Mini PC (KY-108)

Palm-sized device to smart-up your TV with ICS

Android 4.0 Mini PC KY-108 is a device that allows you to convert any display into an Android 4.0 OS based PC. Thanks to its connectivity options, this can be used as a media player, and so, can convert any display into a Smart TV as well. It has a mini HDMI port on the left hand side, a USB port and the power port on the right hand side. It comes with an in-built WiFi adapter and houses a powerful processor.

We tested this device on an LG 42LK430 TV using a USB keyboard and mouse connected to the device via a USB hub. Since Android is primarily a touch-based OS, navigation using a mouse feels alien. It

will definitely take some getting used to. Also the responsiveness of the mouse pointer is not as smooth. The browsing experience however, was quite good. We noticed minor issues with scrolling on certain ad-heavy sites though.

It played most of the video formats we threw at it including .MKV and .MOV formats. The dual-core processor comfortably plays back even 1080p content smoothly.



Since Android games are built around the touch interface and keeping in mind the slow response of the mouse, it is a nightmare to play games on the Mini PC.

Priced at around ₹4,500 this is one of the cheapest ways for you to get an Android ICS experience on your HDTV. Great for casual surfing and

streaming videos. Works great as a second PC

Nimish Sawant